

23 May 2026

Hi Harrison,

Firstly, very impressive draft overall – well done and thank you. It's clear you understand the purpose of a modern hospitality website and the direction already feels very premium, stylish and on-brand for what we want The Bank to become.

The atmosphere, layout and overall feel already work really well and we genuinely appreciate the effort and attention going into it.

I've reviewed the current draft pages as best as I could and overall site structure carefully, including the homepage, menus, drinks, private hire, visit and booking sections. Most of the suggestions below are refinements and consistency improvements rather than major changes, as the overall direction already feels very strong.

Overall Direction

The overall feel should remain:

- Premium but welcoming
- Stylish but relaxed
- Social and atmospheric
- More “social dining” than formal dining

One thing that has always quietly worked in The Bank's favour is that many customers see it as a comfortable, respectful and safe environment, particularly for women, couples and smaller social groups. Without over-promoting this directly, the branding and atmosphere should continue reflecting:

- Friendly professional staff
- Relaxed atmosphere
- Mature social environment
- Quality customer experience

Branding / Consistency

It would be good if we consistently use:

“The Bank

Wines • Cocktails • Tapas

Low Fell”

Alongside:

“Premium wines, cocktails & tapas in the heart of Low Fell.”

The same branding/style should ideally run consistently across:

- Website
- Instagram/Facebook
- Menus
- Flyers/posters
- Event graphics
- Google Business profile

Homepage / Website Structure

The homepage structure already works very well overall and immediately feels premium.

Within a few seconds customers should clearly understand:

“Premium wines, cocktails & tapas in Low Fell.”

The reserve/book buttons are already clearly positioned throughout the site and the booking journey feels simple and easy to follow.

The review/testimonial section also works well and helps reinforce credibility.

A few additions/improvements which may help:

- Guest List / VIP section
- Secret Garden section
- Subtle Uber Eats mention
- More atmosphere/social imagery over time

For **homepage** imagery, one strong approach could be:

- A daytime exterior image (enhanced/blurred) of the building to establish identity and location even an outline &;
- A slightly enhanced/evening exterior image for a more dramatic premium feel
- Smaller supporting images showing:
 - Internal seating areas
 - Cocktails/drinks
 - Secret garden
 - Different rooms and atmospheres
 - Day/night moods
 - Functions/social events

Full-room **imagery** with softly blurred customer faces could also help show atmosphere and scale while still respecting customer privacy.

The moving banners look good and help give the site **energy**. It would just be worth checking they still feel smooth and not too busy on mobile devices.

The website should also subtly reinforce:

- Durham Road / Low Fell location
- Team Valley nearby
- Saltwell Park nearby
- QE Hospital nearby
- Parking/transport where relevant

Opening Hours

The opening hours should feel **definite and established** rather than wording such as “open late”.

Suggested structure:

- Tuesday - 4pm to [confirmed closing time]
- Wednesday & Thursday - 12pm to [confirmed closing time]
- Friday & Saturday - 12pm to [confirmed closing time]
- Sunday - 12pm to [confirmed closing time]

Would also help to clearly display:

- Food serving times
- Last food/drinks orders
- Bank Holiday opening hours
- Festive opening hours, with updates also posted on social media

Suggested wording:

“Private hire and extended opening hours available by arrangement and subject to availability.”

Drinks / Happy Hour

The cocktail offer should be very clear so customers understand when it applies.

For example:

“Cocktail Hour – Selected cocktails 2 for £14

Friday & Saturday | 12pm-5pm and 9pm-10pm”

If weekday offers are available then Add or may change, perhaps add:

“Selected offers may vary – please check our website/social media for current promotions.”

Bookings / Dojo / Private Hire

The booking process already feels clean and straightforward.

It may be worth checking whether the Dojo booking page can show The Bank branding more prominently, for example:

- The Bank logo
- "The Bank - Low Fell"
- Address/contact details
- Brand colours where possible

This helps **reassure** customers they are still booking with the correct venue.

The upstairs lounge/private areas could perhaps be promoted slightly more clearly for:

- Birthdays
- Engagements
- Corporate socials
- Family gatherings
- Celebration of life gatherings
- Private parties

Suggested section title:

"Gatherings & Occasions"

It may also help to include:

"Automated Bookings for groups of 6 or more are subject to confirmation."

Secret Garden / Atmosphere

The outdoor area is a huge selling point and should definitely have its own section:

"Discover Our Secret Garden"

Photography generally should continue focusing on:

- Atmosphere
- Cocktails
- Social groups
- Lighting/candles
- Relaxed premium feel
- Day/night moods
- Private functions and celebrations

Menus / Drinks

Overall the menu and drinks sections already work very well visually.

A few small proofreading/content tweaks:

- "Premium Wines" rather than "Premium Wine"
- "Hand-Battered Cod" rather than "Hand Battered Cod"
- "Choice of vanilla, chocolate or strawberry ice cream"
- "A blend of five spirits" instead of "A blend of 5 liqueurs"

Would also help to eventually include:

- Seasonal cocktails
- Featured wines
- Wine promotions
- Cocktail specials

Loyalty / Guest List

As The Bank already has loyalty cards, if these are continuing they should definitely be subtly promoted throughout the website/socials.

Suggested wording:

"Join Our Guest List"

"As a VIP guest, you'll receive invitations to exclusive events, tastings and special evenings throughout the year."

This feels much more premium than a standard loyalty/discount scheme.

Another idea which could work well long term:

"Leave us a review for the chance to win a monthly Bank gift voucher."

This could tie into:

- Guest List sign-ups
- Loyalty cards
- Event invitations
- Email marketing

If collecting customer emails, it would be worth ensuring guests can optionally opt in to:

- Guest List/newsletters
- Events/promotions
- VIP evenings

This could gradually help build a very useful customer database over time for:

- Cocktail nights
- Festive events
- Seasonal offers
- Private hire promotions

Obviously just worth ensuring any customer data collection/email marketing is GDPR compliant with clear opt-in wording.

Delivery / Uber Eats

As The Bank also offers takeaway/delivery via Uber Eats, this is probably worth subtly referencing somewhere on the website.

Suggested wording:

- "Available for delivery via Uber Eats"
- "Enjoy The Bank at home with Uber Eats delivery"

Probably best included on:

- Menu/food pages
- Footer
- Mobile quick links

Social Media / Google

The website should clearly include:

- Instagram link
- Facebook link
- Google reviews link
- Clickable phone/email
- Google Maps integration

It is also worth checking that if someone finds us via Google, the website and Google Business listing connect properly with Google Maps/directions.

Google Business profile should also stay fully updated with:

- Opening hours
- Photos
- Menus
- Branding
- Events
- Festive hours
- Reviews

Mobile Compatibility

Before going live, it is very important the website auto-sizes and displays properly across:

- iPhone
- Android
- Tablets
- Desktop
- Smaller screens

Key priorities:

- Fast loading
- Easy scrolling
- Easy booking
- Correct image positioning
- Readable text
- Thumb-friendly buttons
- Menus and banners not overlapping or feeling cramped

Accessibility

Also worth adding somewhere small within the Visit/Accessibility section:

"Accessible WC and wheelchair access available to the ground level and Secret Garden area – please call ahead if you require assistance."

Footer / Operational Details

The footer and operational sections already look professional overall.

Would also help to include or retain:

- Terms & Conditions
- Privacy Policy
- Cookie Policy
- Social links
- Licensing wording where appropriate

For example:

"Opening hours and events may vary subject to availability and licensing requirements."

"Challenge 25 policy in operation."

Also worth adding:

"Please inform staff of any allergies or dietary requirements."

Overall

The website is already heading in a really strong direction and the venue itself has massive potential due to:

- The building identity
- Premium Durham Road location
- Strong local demographic
- Nearby businesses and attractions
- Flexible social/event opportunities

The main objective now is refining consistency and positioning so everything feels polished, premium and recognisable across every customer touchpoint.

I also don't think a website like this is ever fully "finished", as it is effectively a living business profile which will naturally continue evolving over time with new events, imagery, offers, reviews and customer feedback once live. There will no doubt always be the odd observation or criticism from customers as things evolve, but that's all part of developing and refining the brand over time.

Sorry if this looks like a lot – most of it is simply expanded guidance for clarity and consistency to help avoid ambiguity later on. Overall the direction already looks genuinely very strong.

Thanks again.